

seeing these search results and would prefer it remain a local search, you can disable Bing search. To do this, you'll have to tweak around in the registry. Open up the start menu and type `regedit` to launch the Windows Registry Editor. Then navigate to **HKEY\_CURRENT\_USER\SOFTWARE\Policies\Microsoft\Windows\Explorer**. If this doesn't exist, simply create a new folder named **Explorer** in the **Windows** folder. In explorer, create a new DWORD, which is a 32-bit value. Name it **DisableSearchBoxSuggestions** and then set the value to 1. Simply double-click on it to do so. After that, restart your computer and you're done.

## CREATE KEYBOARD SHORTCUTS FOR FAVOURITE APPS

At this point, we're sure that all of your favourite apps are pinned to the taskbar for quick access. Otherwise, it's the hassle of finding the icon on the desktop, or typing the name out in the Start menu. There's actually a much faster way to launch your most used apps. Simply give them their own custom keyboard shortcut. First, open command prompt by simply typing `cmd` in the start menu search. Once it's opened, enter **explorer shell:AppsFolder**. This will open a window which contains all of your installed apps. Find the ones that you

can skip this lock screen entirely to save you some time on startup. To get rid of this screen, head to the registry editor again, and navigate to **HKEY\_LOCAL\_MACHINE\SOFTWARE\Policies\Microsoft\Windows** and create a new key called **Personalization** if it doesn't exist. If it does, or if you've just made it, create a DWORD (32-bit) value called **NoLockScreen** and set it to 1. You're done.

## FORCE WINDOWS TO CLOSE APPS ON SHUTDOWN

You must have come across this issue where upon shutting down your system, Windows prompts you with the so-and-so apps are still running. It also gives you the Shut down anyway option, but this can be a hassle, if you gave the shutdown command and headed off somewhere, only to come back and see that your system didn't shut itself down. In order to force Windows to close apps on shutdown, once again, head to the registry editor, and navigate to **\HKEY\_CURRENT\_USER\Control Panel\Desktop** and create three strings. The first, **AutoEndTasks** and set its value to 1. Then create **WaitToKillAppTimeOut** and set it to 2000. Finally, create **HungAppTimeOut** and set that also to 2000. This will cause Windows to automatically shut down, giving the apps a 2 second delay to shut themselves down. This time can be further shortened, but it isn't advised, since the apps might not get enough time to close themselves.

## ADD A WINDOWS NEWS BAR

Unless you have a news aggregation app, keeping track of the news can be difficult and rather tedious. The alternative is manually scrolling to multiple different news pages, which is also time-consuming. Windows has a solution to this, called the News Bar. The News Bar continually updates itself with headlines from various publications. It does, however, take up a lot of your screen. To get the Microsoft News Bar, head to the Windows Store and find the News bar app's store page. Here click Get. After the app is downloaded and installed, simply Launch it, either from the store page, or through the Start Menu. The feature is still in beta though, so expect some bugs and missing features for the time being.

use commonly and put a shortcut on the desktop. You can skip this if you've already got shortcuts for the same on your desktop. Now, right click on the shortcut and head to Properties. Here, in the shortcut tab, there is a **Shortcut Key** field. Select the field and simply input your key combo, it could be `CTRL + ALT + [letter or number]`. Repeat for all the apps you want.

## GET RID OF THE LOCK SCREEN

When you first boot your computer, you're greeted with a lock screen that you need to click on, or press a key to remove. If you have a password, that step comes next. This can usually have some notifications or other things on it, which is usually irrelevant. Making this step just one-extra step to getting to your computer. You

## HAVE MAGNIFIER READ TEXT ALOUD

Windows has a handy little tool called Magnifier, which is basically a screen-magnifying feature used to zoom in on the little details and make things easier to read, among other things. To that end, you can take this a step further, by having Magnifier read text aloud. In order to use this feature, you'll need to access Magnifier via Settings, or simply press the **Win key + Plus sign (+)**, there, select the 'Read from here' option and use your mouse pointer to choose where you'd like Magnifier to start reading aloud from. 

